



HBW OWNER RESOURCE

Five-Minute Boat Trailer Check

Walk around once before every road trip. Fix the problem before the trailer moves.

TOW VEHICLE

BOAT / TRAILER

DATE

Hitch and connections

- ☐ Correct hitch ball and coupler. Coupler fully seated, latched and pinned.
- ☐ Safety chains crossed under the tongue with secure, latched hooks.
- ☐ Breakaway cable attached separately to the tow vehicle where fitted.
- ☐ Tongue jack fully raised and locked. Wheel chocks removed.
- ☐ Trailer plug connected with enough slack for turns, but clear of the road.

Boat and load

- ☐ Bow eye tight to the winch post. Winch strap and safety chain secure.
- ☐ Transom tie-downs secure. Loose gear removed or tied down.
- ☐ Motor positioned and supported exactly as the engine, trailer and support makers direct.
- ☐ Drain plug managed for the road and launch conditions. Check local invasive-species rules.
- ☐ No load in the boat unless the trailer is designed and rated for it.

Tires, hubs and hardware

- ☐ Tires inflated to the trailer tire or trailer-maker specification when cold.
- ☐ No cracks, bulges, exposed cords or unsafe tread. Check the spare too.
- ☐ Wheel nuts secure to the specified torque. Recheck after service or wheel removal.
- ☐ Hubs, bearings, suspension and axle show no heat, play, leaks or damage.
- ☐ Licence plate, fenders and mud protection are secure.

Lights and legal check

- ☐ Tail, brake, signal, marker and licence-plate lights work.
- ☐ Mirrors provide a clear view behind the load.
- ☐ Trailer permit and plate are current and available.
- ☐ Tow vehicle, hitch, trailer, tires and brakes are rated for the actual load.
- ☐ Ontario requires trailer brakes at 1,360 kg gross trailer weight or more.

ONTARIO RULE TO REMEMBER

A trailer needs two separate attachment methods. If chains are used, Ontario says they must cross under the tongue and the hooks must resist accidental detachment. If anything fails this walk-around, don't tow.